WorkRadar: Product Requirements

One AI-assisted view of a team's work, so a manager knows what needs them without opening four tools.

Ashok · v1.0 · October 2026
Status: MVP built on mock data

01 Problem statement

An engineering manager's team works across Jira, GitHub, Slack and email. Each tool shows its own slice and its own idea of priority, and none of them answers the manager's real morning questions: **what is the top work today, what happened, what needs me now, and who is blocked?** Managers rebuild that picture by hand, tab by tab, several times a day. The costliest gap is work that is blocked *on the manager* (a decision, a sign-off, a reply). It sits in a DM or an email thread, invisible in every tracker, and usually surfaces only at the next stand-up, a day late.

02 Target users

- **Primary:** engineering managers and team leads with 5–12 reports whose work spans a tracker, a code host, chat and email.
- **Secondary:** tech leads who triage for their team, and product managers who track delivery across the same tools.
- **Later:** directors who need a cross-team risk view (not in MVP).

03 Key pain points

- **Tool-hopping:** four tools and dozens of tabs to answer one question.
- **Invisible blockers on the manager:** asks live in DMs, not in any status field.
- **Conflicting priority:** a P2 ticket, a CTO email and an on-call ping use different scales.
- **No "what happened today":** merges, deploys and closes are scattered across feeds.
- **Search is per-tool:** one customer issue spans a ticket, a PR, a thread and an email.
- **Noise:** FYIs look the same as asks that need action.

04 User personas

PERSONA	CONTEXT	GOAL	FRUSTRATION TODAY
Ashok, Engineering Manager (primary)	Payments team of 7, owns on-call and a customer escalation path; meetings fill most afternoons.	Know the three things that need him within two minutes of sitting down, and unblock people before they lose a day.	Found out at stand-up that Sara had waited two days for his sign-off, which was buried in a Slack DM.
Marcus Lee, Tech Lead	Codes most of the day and triages for a team of 5.	Triage in five minutes, then return to focus time.	Tracker priority and real urgency disagree, so he checks everything himself.
Elena Rossi, Director (later)	Four teams, weekly risk reviews.	See which teams are blocked, and on whom, without asking each manager.	Status reports are a week stale by the time she reads them.

05 User journey (Ashok's morning with WorkRadar)

9:00 · ORIENT
Open the dashboard
Four counts answer the four questions; a Claude-written briefing names the day's story with links to each item.

9:02 · ACT
Do the "Do next"
Opens the item, reads why it ranks high, drafts a reply with AI, copies it to Slack.

9:05 · TRIAGE
Clear the Now tier
Assigns the unowned bug, snoozes the headcount email to Friday, marks a handled item done, each with Undo.

9:10 · UNBLOCK
Check who's blocked
Work blocked on him is listed first; he nudges a reviewer whose PR blocks the incident fix.

ANY TIME · RECALL
Search
"Acme" returns the incident ticket, the CTO's email and the on-call thread together.

Today the same loop means opening Jira, GitHub, Slack and email separately and holding the joins in his head.

06 Success metrics

METRIC	DEFINITION	MVP TARGET (6-WEEK PILOT)
North star: time to first action	Open WorkRadar → first Assign, Done, Snooze or drafted reply on a *Now* item	Median under 2 minutes
Blocked-on-manager clearance	Share of items blocked on the manager resolved within 4 working hours	80% or more
Blocker age	Median hours an item stays blocked, versus the 2 weeks before pilot	30% lower
Habit	Managers who open WorkRadar on 4 of 5 working days	60% of pilot managers
Briefing usefulness	Thumbs-up rate on the briefing; clicks on its item links	70% thumbs-up
Guardrail: trust	Briefings reported as factually wrong; every cited item is validated against source data	Under 2%

07 MVP scope

In: one team; Jira, GitHub, Slack and email as mock data; dashboard; AI briefing with item citations and a rules-based fallback; priority feed with an explained score; item detail; cross-source search; Assign, Mark done and Snooze with Undo; source-sync, AI-failure and empty states.

Out: real OAuth integrations and write-back to source tools; notifications and digests; multiple teams; user-tuned scoring; native mobile apps.

Design principle: rules rank, AI explains. Ranking is deterministic so the order is stable and every point is visible; Claude only summarises and drafts, and every item it cites must exist in the data.

08 Assumptions

- Managers will check one dashboard daily if it saves them the tool-hop.
- Source data carries enough structure (status, owner, due date, severity, links) to rank reliably.
- "Blocked on the manager" can be detected from blocked statuses plus direct asks; the MVP's mock data marks it explicitly.
- One identity per person can be mapped across tools.
- Read-only OAuth scopes for these tools are acceptable to IT and security.
- Managers trust a transparent rule-based order more than an AI-chosen one.
- One cached briefing call per page load keeps model cost low.

09 Features

	FEATURE	WHY IT MATTERS	MVP
MUST	Unified feed from four sources	The core promise: one place instead of four.	**Built (mock)**
MUST	Priority score with visible reasons and Now / Today / Later tiers	A shared scale across tools; reasons make the order trustworthy.	**Built**
MUST	AI briefing with item citations and a labelled fallback	Answers the four questions in under a minute of reading.	**Built**
MUST	Who's blocked, with blocked-on-you first	Targets the costliest gap: work waiting on the manager.	**Built**
MUST	What happened today timeline	Merges, deploys, closes and the manager's own actions in one list.	**Built**
MUST	Item detail; cross-source search	Context and recall without leaving WorkRadar.	**Built**
MUST	Assign, Mark done, Snooze, each with Undo	Triage where the manager reads, not in another tab.	**Built**
MUST	Source health, empty and error states	A missing source must never look like "nothing to do".	**Built**
NICE	AI-drafted reply or nudge per item	Turns an insight into a sent message.	**Built**
NICE	Natural-language questions ("what's blocking Acme?")	Faster recall than keywords for fuzzy questions.	Later
NICE	Write-back to Jira and Slack; 9am digest in Slack or email	Close the loop where the team already works.	Later
NICE	Tunable scoring weights; calendar context; director view; blocker-age trends	Fit each team's norms and scale beyond one team.	Later